CLASS 8 — SOCIAL SCIENCE · HARD LEVEL CHAPTER TEST SET 1

Chapter 2: **Reshaping India's Political Map** | RBSE Pattern | Session 2026–27

Time: 1 Hour 30 Minutes Name: _____ Roll No.: _____ **Maximum Marks: 40**

General Instructions:

1. All questions are compulsory.
2. Q. 1–10 are Objective Type (1 mark each).
3. Q. 11–14 are Very Short Answer Type (2 marks each).
4. Q. 15–18 are Short Answer Type (3 marks each).
5. Q. 19–20 are Long Answer Type (5 marks each).
6. Internal choice is given in Q. 17 to 20.
7. Write the question number before each answer.
8. Hard level: application and higher-order questions.

SECTION — A (Objective Type Questions) 10 × 1 = 10

Choose the correct option and write it in your answer book.

1. Source: 'Two of every three sultans came to the throne by removing the previous one.' This suggests that the Sultanate 1

(a) lacked orderly succession **(b)** had no sultans
(c) was very stable **(d)** was elective

2. Which can be inferred from the paik system? 1

(a) No army **(b)** State relied on labour service for land
(c) Free education **(d)** Wages in cash

3. Which statement reflects a balanced view of Aurangzeb? 1

(a) He expanded the empire but strained its finances and harmony
(b) He was perfect
(c) He was Akbar's son
(d) He was a failure in everything

4. A coin of base metal is declared equal to a silver coin. After some months silver coins disappear from the market. This is explained by 1

(a) silver becoming cheap
(b) people hoarding silver and forging copies
(c) royal gift
(d) trade rising

5. Which is the best example of a 'cause' in history? 1

(a) Heavy taxes leading to rebellion **(b)** A king's name
(c) The date of a battle **(d)** A map

6. The fall of Hampi illustrates that 1

(a) a rich city can be destroyed after a single defeat
(b) forts are strong always
(c) rivers protect
(d) trade is useless

7. A traveller praises Hampi as a city 'as large as Rome'. This evidence best shows 1

(a) its weakness **(b)** its small size
(c) wealth and size of Vijayanagara **(d)** its foreign rule

8. The Khalsa initiation with five Ks created 1

(a) a tax office **(b)** a university
(c) unity and discipline in the community **(d)** a trade guild

9. Both Rani Durgavati and Lachit Borphukan are remembered for 1

(a) joining Akbar **(b)** trading in horses
(c) writing history **(d)** resisting a stronger Mughal army

10. A king builds a temple as a chariot of the Sun god and records victories on it. The purpose combines 1

(a) farming **(b)** defence only
(c) religion and political display **(d)** trade only

SECTION — B (Very Short Answer Type) — 4 × 2 = 8

Answer in about 20–30 words each.

11. 'Two of every three sultans removed their predecessors.' What does this show? 2

12. What does Krishnadevaraya's Amuktamalyada tell us about him? 2

13. Why did the Mughals use mansabs rather than hereditary jagirs? 2

14. Why would a historian doubt a court chronicle's praise of its king? 2

SECTION — C (Short Answer Type) — 4 × 3 = 12

Answer in about 40–60 words each.

15. Source: 'The new coins are made of copper but must be accepted as silver.' Identify the ruler and explain the result. 3

16. Case: A temple has a chariot design and records the king's victories. Explain what this tells about the age. 3

17. Examine why Vijayanagara's wealth made it a target. 3

OR

Source: 'Hampi is as large as Rome and the best provided of all cities.' Who wrote this kind of account and what is its value? 3

18. Argue whether Aurangzeb's policies were the main cause of the Mughal decline. 3

OR

A merchant uses hundis. Explain two advantages and a risk. 3

SECTION — D (Long Answer Type) — 2 × 5 = 10

Answer in about 100–150 words each.

19. Source: 'The Sultan moved the capital 1,100 km south and introduced token coins.' Evaluate the aims, outcomes and lessons. 5

OR

Discuss how trade, ports and credit instruments such as hundis supported medieval kingdoms. 5

20. Analyse the factors that explain the rise of Mughal power under Babur and Akbar. 5

OR

Assess the role of temples and monuments as sources of history and instruments of power. 5

END OF QUESTION PAPER — Total: 40 Marks